

Apple Cinema Display 20-inch

When we first saw the iMac, we were surprised by its size, but amazed by the quality and clarity of the display. The sad part is that this display is only available with the iMac. So, Apple came out with the dazzling Cinema Display series, but stubbornly kept its connectivity options limited to Apple computers. The Cinema Display that we got had the same issue, but a little research revealed that adapters that will let you connect them to regular PCs are available.

The Apple Cinema Display comes in a 20-inch wide-screen version, but even bigger ones are available. The display is encased in a stunning fibre-glass body, and is lighter than the LG 23-inch. This unit could not be tested using our standard tests, as we couldn't connect it to a PC. Also, the resolution on the Apple G5 was set to 1,680 x 1,050, which isn't available on the PC. It should default to 1,600 x 1,024 if connected to a computer with a high enough resolution for this monitor. As of now, only 3DLabs has made a video card—the Oxygen GVX420—which supports the Apple display natively.

We received a G5 to test this display, and it was just magical. We just couldn't find any dead pixels, bright spots or colour differences; in fact we couldn't find anything wrong at all. We



put on the *Terminator 2: Judgement Day* DVD to check the quality of the display, and found ourselves ducking to avoid bullets. Images were razor-sharp, and colours as vibrant as we've ever seen. In short, this monitor is absolutely brilliant.

The Apple Cinema Display will find favour with all users who use Macs for video editing and designing. As for PC users, help is at hand in the form of third-party solutions that allow you to connect it to a PC, but you'll need a heavy-duty card that can support a resolution of 1,600 x 1,024 with ease.

+ Excellent display quality

– Cannot be connected to a PC without third-party connectors

Price: Rs 86,600 plus taxes

poor performance on this test means graphics can look dull and lifeless. Sharpness demands that the colour change sharply at edges.

In the 16 intensities test for primary colours, the CMV CT-529A and the NEC AccuSync LCD51V were good performers. What this shows is that the auto-calibration feature of these panels is set better than on the others. This test is of importance for digital imaging artists, and, especially, layout artists who make marketing collateral, brochures and magazine covers—where proper colour reproduction and variation amongst shades is critical.

The viewable angle test saw amazing consistency: All panels were visible from 150 degrees. However, different panels had their issues—some displayed a slight red tinge, and others a slight blue tinge, at wide angles. We suggest users sit right in front of the monitor, and if there are more people around, it would be a good idea to space them all within the 120-130 degree range.

At the end, in the 15-inch LCD category, it was the two CMV models that made it to the top. A 0.11-point difference in per-

formance scores between the CT-522A and 529A was the decider, and we awarded the CT-522A both the best performance and best value award.

Conclusion

The 15-inch LCD category is hot right now, because of falling prices. In our tests, it was close competition between the CMV, BenQ and Samsung monitors.

The CMV monitors got to the top slot—they have better features as well as commendable performance. The BenQ FP567s wasn't far behind, though. It's also a great looking model. The Samsung 152s returned some terrific results in a few tests—it carved a niche for itself; it's a great monitor when finer details are more important.

The Acer AL511 and the Philips 150C aren't really up to the mark in this category, whether it's about features or performance.

DECISION MAKER

You need	A monitor for home use—working on documents, e-mail, surfing the 'Net and playing games over the weekend	A compact monitor for your small office where display quality is important, with low power consumption	A monitor for gaming use, where high refresh rate, brilliant colour reproduction and brightness are important	A monitor for designing and graphics applications. It should be able to reproduce fine details and colours, and offer accurate geometry	A monitor to watch DVD movies, VCDs and TV programmes
Look for	A compact monitor that has 110 MHz video bandwidth for better refresh rates at high resolutions	An LCD panel, as it consumes less power and saves a lot of space. It is flatter and brighter than a CRT monitor, and strains your eyes less	A 19-inch or 21-inch Aperture Grille monitor for the best results. Also make sure it can handle a refresh rate of 75 Hz at 1,600 x 1,200 pixels	For best geometry results, 17-inch or larger LCD panels are best. You can also try 19-inch Aperture Grille technology-based CRT monitors	A wide format (16:9) LCD is what you should look for. Also look for wall mounting capability
Our pick	Samsung 763MB, LG E700S	SyncMaster 152s	Philips 109P4, NEC MultiSync 912SB	Samsung SyncMaster 1723MP, Samsung SyncMaster 172s, NEC MultiSync 912SB (CRT)	LG L2320A, Philips 170T
Price	Rs 8,500 - 9,500	Rs 18,000 - 22,000	Rs 18,000 - 25,000	Rs 24,000 - 38,000	Rs 50,000 - 1,85,000